

Lemon Herb Roast Chicken (Variation 3)

Tags: chicken, dinner, low-carb, gluten-free, sunday-roast | Prep: 15 min | Cook: 90 min | Serves: 10

Ingredients

- 2.5 whole chicken (about 1.8 kg)
- 5 lemons, 1 zested and halved, 1 juiced
- 10 garlic cloves, 2 minced, 2 whole
- 7.5 tbsp unsalted butter, softened
- 2.5 tbsp fresh marjoram, finely chopped
- 2.5 tbsp fresh rosemary, finely chopped
- 2.5 tbsp fresh basil, finely chopped
- 3.8 tsp fine salt
- 2.5 tsp black pepper
- 2.5 onion, quartered
- 1250 ml chicken stock

Method

1. Remove chicken from fridge 30 minutes before cooking. Preheat oven to 220 °C.
2. Mix softened butter, lemon zest, minced garlic, rosemary, thyme, parsley, salt, and pepper into a herb butter.
3. Pat chicken completely dry inside and out with kitchen paper.
4. Gently lift the skin from the breast and push herb butter underneath, spreading it evenly over the breast meat.
5. Rub remaining butter over the skin. Season the cavity generously with salt and pepper.
6. Stuff the cavity with halved lemon, onion quarters, and whole garlic cloves.
7. Tie the legs together with kitchen twine. Place chicken breast-side up in a roasting tray.
8. Pour stock into the tray. Squeeze lemon juice over the bird.
9. Roast for 20 minutes at 220 °C to brown the skin, then reduce to 180 °C and roast for a further 50–60 minutes.
10. Chicken is done when juices run clear and internal temperature reaches 75 °C at the thickest part of the thigh.
11. Rest for 15 minutes uncovered before carving. Make gravy from the pan juices.

Chef Tips

- Drying the skin thoroughly is the single most important step for crispy skin.
- Resting is non-negotiable — skipping it causes all the juices to run out when carving.
- The herb butter can be prepared up to 2 days in advance and refrigerated.